AWS Windows EC2 + RDP (Remmina) – Cheat Sheet

Quick-reference guide for **practice, revision, and interviews**. Minimal explanations, maximum clarity.

1️⃣ AWS Console Basics

- Login: https://console.aws.amazon.com/
- Service: **EC2**
- Region: Choose one (e.g., Europe–Stockholm, Mumbai)

2️⃣ Launch Windows EC2 (Quick Steps)

EC2 → Launch instance

- Name: `windows-ec2-task1`
- AMI: **Microsoft Windows Server 2019/2022 Base**
- Instance type: `t3.micro` / `t2.micro`
- Key pair: Create new → `.pem`
- Auto-assign Public IP: **Enable**
- Security group:
- Allow **RDP**
- Source: `0.0.0.0/0`
- Storage: Default (30 GB)
- Launch instance

Wait for: - State: **Running** - Status checks: **Passed**

3️⃣ RDP / Network Essentials

- RDP Port: **3389**
- Protocol: **TCP**
- Username: `Administrator`
- Access controlled by **Security Group**

4️⃣ Get Windows Password

EC2 → Instances → Select instance → **Connect** → **RDP Client**

- Click **Get password**
- Upload `.pem` key
- Decrypt

Save: - Username: `Administrator` - Password

5️⃣ Install Remmina (Ubuntu)

```
sudo apt update
sudo apt install remmina remmina-plugin-rdp -y
```

6️⃣ Remmina RDP Configuration

Create **New Connection**:

- Protocol: **RDP**
- Name: AWS Windows EC2
- Server: `<Public IPv4>` or `<Public DNS>`
- Username: `Administrator`
- Password: (decrypted)
- Domain: *(empty)*

Advanced: - Security protocol: **RDP**

Save → Double-click to connect

7️⃣ First Windows Login

- Wait for "Preparing Windows"
- Windows Server desktop appears

8️⃣ CMD & System Info (Core Task)

Inside Windows:

```
systeminfo
```

Shows: - OS name & version - Hostname - System type - Memory

9️⃣ Mandatory Screenshots

- EC2 instance **Running**
- Windows desktop (RDP)
- CMD with `systeminfo`

🔟 Stop vs Terminate

- **Stop** → Temporary (storage still billed)
- **Terminate** → Permanent delete (recommended)

Terminate: EC2 → Instances → Instance state → **Terminate**

1️⃣1️⃣ Common Issues & Fixes

❌ RDP not connecting - Check instance is **Running** - Check **RDP (3389)** allowed in Security Group - Use Public DNS instead of IP

❌ Black screen in Remmina - Create full profile (don't use Quick Connect) - Set Security protocol = RDP

1️⃣2️⃣ One-Line Interview Explanation

"I launched a Windows EC2 instance on AWS, configured a security group to allow RDP on port 3389, decrypted the Administrator password using a key pair, connected from Ubuntu via Remmina, and verified the system using the `systeminfo` command."

1️⃣3️⃣ What You Practiced

- EC2 provisioning
- Windows VM access
- RDP from Linux
- Cloud security basics
- Cost-safe cleanup

✅ End of Cheat Sheet